■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 25, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *New York sues prediction market Polymarket, calling it an unlicensed gambling operation*

The Angle: *Polymarket blew up as the go-to place to bet on everything from elections to pop culture moments, and now New York is trying to shut that down by calling it illegal gambling - a legal fight that could decide whether prediction markets survive nationwide.*

- **New York** has filed a lawsuit against **Polymarket**, arguing the platform is running an **unlicensed gambling operation** in the state.
- **Polymarket** lets users bet real money on the outcome of real-world events - everything from elections to pop culture - and has become one of the most talked-about betting platforms around.
- The suit raises the bigger question regulators keep circling back to: is a 'prediction market' actually just gambling with better branding?

The Debate Starter

- Is betting on 'will this happen' any different from betting on a football game - or is that just semantics?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cp24.com/news/world/2026/09/24/new-york-sues-prediction-market-polymarket-calling-it-an-unlicensed-gambling-operation/

■ *Japanese used bookstores see 5x sales surge as books are being bought by the ton, one 50-ton order sent to the US for AI scanning and destruction — multitude of suspicious bulk buys thought to end up in foreign AI scan and shred facilities*

The Angle: *Used bookstores in Japan are getting cleaned out by mystery bulk buyers paying by weight, not by title, and the trail leads to overseas facilities where books get scanned and destroyed - likely to feed AI training data. It's a weird real-world side effect of the AI boom that nobody saw coming, and it's got book lovers spooked.*

- **Used bookstore sales in Japan** have jumped **5x** as buyers snap up inventory in bulk.
- Books are reportedly being bought **by the ton**, not by title or author.
- One single shipment weighing **50 tons** was sent to the **US**.
- The suspected destination: **AI scan-and-shred facilities** that digitize books then destroy the physical copies.

The Mystery Angle

- Would it creep you out to know your old paperbacks got scanned by a robot and then shredded?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/artificial-intelligence/japanese-used-bookstores-see-5x-sales-surge-as-books-are-being-bought-by-the-ton-one-50-ton-order-sent-to-the-us-for-ai-scanning-and-destruction-multitude-of-suspicious-bulk-buys-thought-to-end-up-in-foreign-ai-scan-and-shred-facilities

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■ *Mamdani's populist style is all over the Toronto election race*

The Angle: *Mamdani's populist style is all over the Toronto election race*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/toronto-mamdani-municipal-election-9.7357207?cmp=rss

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■ *Wheelchair user says ‘discriminatory’ Habs policy forced him to beg for tickets*

The Angle: *This isn't really a hockey story, it's a discrimination story — a disabled fan says the Canadiens quietly gutted access to game tickets for people who need accessible seating, and that's a fairness issue that hits way beyond Montreal.*

- **Joey Racanelli** says the Bell Centre changed its policy so wheelchair-accessible seating can't be bought online like every other ticket.
- Fans needing accessible seats must instead **call or show up in person** to the ticket office.
- Racanelli says the change was made **quietly**, with no heads-up to fans who rely on it.
- The new system has limited him to **just one game for the entire season**.

The Debate Starter

- Should accessibility seating ever be harder to book than a regular ticket — call the show if you or someone you know has hit this same wall.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/wheelchair-user-says-discriminatory-habs-policy-forced-him-to-beg-for-tickets-9.7357204?cmp=rss

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■ *Video appears to show stalker doctor wiping blood from where model was murdered and stuffed in suitcase*

The Angle: *Surveillance video appears to show the accused killer cleaning the crime scene minutes after allegedly murdering the woman he'd been stalking — a real-life true-crime twist with the kind of shock value that stops people mid-scroll.*

- Video appears to show a **doctor** wiping what looks like **blood** in an apartment hallway in **Colombia**.
- He's accused of **stalking** the victim, described as a **model**, before allegedly killing her.
- Her body was reportedly found stuffed inside a **suitcase**.

The Watercooler Moment

- It's the kind of case that makes you wonder how well you actually know the people fixated on you.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/25/world-news/video-appears-to-show-stalker-doctor-wiping-blood-from-where-model-was-murdered-and-stuffed-in-suitcase/

Backup options:

■ *Northern California to get 25-acre surf resort with bungalows, hotel as plans revealed*

The Angle: *County planners just approved a massive man-made surf resort — the kind of wild, aspirational build that instantly becomes a bucket-list target and a "wait, where is this?" conversation for anyone who's ever wanted to learn to surf without dealing with the ocean.*

- The project sits on **25 acres** in Northern California.
- Centerpiece is a giant **surf lagoon** and **wave pool** for artificial waves.
- Plans also include a **hotel**, **bungalows**, and a **skate park** on site.
- **County planners** have officially approved the development.

The Bucket List Debate

- Would you book a stay just to surf a man-made wave, or does it need to be the real ocean to count?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/25/lifestyle/california-surf-resort-with-wave-pool-hotel-and-skate-park-targets-2027-groundbreaking/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Blue Jays, Maple Leafs eliminated from playoffs*

The Angle: *Two of Canada's biggest sports franchises bounced from the postseason - it's the annual gut-punch that gets every Toronto sports bar arguing about what needs to change.*

- **Toronto Blue Jays** are officially eliminated from the playoffs.
- **Toronto Maple Leafs** are also out of the postseason picture.
- Back-to-back exits reignite the same old question: what's it going to take for a Toronto title?

The Debate Starter

- Which elimination stings more for Toronto fans right now - the Jays or the Leafs?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thebeaverton.com/2026/09/blue-jays-maple-leafs-eliminated-from-playoffs/

■■ *Japan hungry for more Canadian energy, new envoy says*

The Angle: *Japan's newly posted ambassador is publicly pitching for more Canadian energy exports — a signal that Canada's LNG ambitions could get a major Asian customer just as the energy debate heats up at home.*

- Japan's **new envoy to Canada** says the country is **"hungry" for more Canadian energy**
- Comes as Asian economies look to diversify energy supply away from other global hot spots
- Puts fresh spotlight on Canada's stalled/slow-moving **LNG export projects** on the west coast

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be racing to build more LNG terminals to cash in on demand like this, or is that a climate promise we'd be breaking?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/politics/article-japan-hungry-for-more-canadian-energy-new-envoy-says/

■■ *Ottawa signs preliminary deal with Swedish firm Saab for 6 GlobalEye aircraft*

The Angle: *Ottawa just inked a preliminary deal for six high-tech surveillance aircraft, and the twist is they'll be built at home with Bombardier — a defense deal that doubles as a jobs story.*

- Federal government announced a **preliminary agreement** for **six GlobalEye** detection aircraft
- Built by Swedish defense firm **Saab**
- In partnership with Canada's own **Bombardier**
- Deal covers advanced airborne surveillance/detection tech

The Debate Starter

- Multibillion-dollar defense deals always spark the same fight: is this smart investment in Canadian jobs, or should that money go elsewhere?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/government-signs-preliminary-deal-saab-globaleye-9.7358021?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *Would you wear an air-quality sensor on your body?*

The Angle: *Artists are turning invisible smog into wearable pieces you can actually see on someone's body, which is a wild hook for a bigger conversation about how bad air quality is getting - and it lands next to news about a killer El Niño and a Nunavut town ditching diesel for solar.*

- A new wave of **wearable art** is designed to make **air pollution** visible on the human body.
- This year's **El Niño** is being mapped for exactly where and when it's expected to turn deadly.

- A scrapyard in a **Nunavut** community switched to **solar power** to cut its reliance on **diesel**.
- The roundup comes from **CBC's** environmental newsletter, tying pollution, climate, and clean energy into one snapshot.

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually strap on a visible pollution sensor - or would you rather not know how bad the air really is?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/climate/what-on-earth-bill-air-quality-art-9.7356388?cmp=rss

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■ *What Canadians should know about cellphone searches at U.S. border*

The Angle: *Millions of Canadians cross the U.S. border every year for work, shopping, or travel - and most have no idea border agents can dig through their phone without a warrant. It's a privacy story that hits home for anyone with a passport.*

- **U.S. Customs and Border Protection** can search phones, laptops and tablets without a warrant - even for **Canadian citizens** just visiting.
- Agents don't need to suspect a crime to ask a traveler to unlock a device at the border.
- Refusing to unlock a phone won't get you arrested, but it can mean device seizure or denied entry for non-citizens.
- Experts recommend Canadians know their rights and consider what's on their phone before they even get in line.

The Cross-Border Question

- Would you hand over your phone to a border agent, or turn around and go home?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimAFBVV95cUxNRDFEMjhjYmhnSzYyaV9mbWwtaTREMUR2Nnc1a3J4TTZBNVZoT3FQN1p2MURyblgwWGpQS01PejVZQ3ZUdGN3bFhhcGhIODhCa0pIZlgwcmtXSm10aG8xOVhVNVp6VDhHQ3g5MlRrWDZIQ2VWR20tdXc5SkdNTUhwX1RQT3ZGRnBjckY0eXJ1aW9NbWMyTTBaeg?oc=5

■ *A routine house evaluation uncovers rare antique hiding ‘in plain sight’*

The Angle: *Everyone's got a weird thing sitting in their house they've never had appraised - this is the story that makes people run to Google their grandma's lamp.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's the one item in your house you secretly hope is worth a fortune?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxObFJFSVNabDlwdTZKV0dyZzFPRG1KVmFBNjctVjZyeW8xeGZHTUVwLXBfLUlSWGp3UEpDQzRZeENCdGlkS2RzMXlrYjltMWdWR25kZ3ptRzVWckpRRG5TeGNoVk0ta1YtMHBSNC1fdnZqWklXbXpkblBjb1doVW5sUENHQ2VwTC03UWExc0xZaWphVEEwbXZMOXdMN2p4WFJ0YmZEZjVFa2NOdDRiTHNn?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Tiffani Thiessen gets real about Hollywood work and pay since ‘Saved by the Bell’*

The Angle: *A 'Saved by the Bell' icon is back with a new Freeform show, and she's dishing on just how much Hollywood paychecks and on-set life have changed since her teen-star days — instant nostalgia bait with a real industry gossip hook.*

- **Tiffani Thiessen** stopped by **Page Six Radio**, chatting with hosts **Danny Murphy** and **Evan Real**.
- She's starring in the new **Freeform** series **"Coven Academy."**
- She opened up about how pay and working conditions have changed since her **"Saved by the Bell"** days.
- **Page Six Radio** airs weekdays on **SiriusXM**.

The Then-and-Now Angle

- Ask listeners: what's the biggest way their own industry has changed pay-wise since the '90s?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/tiffani-thiessen-gets-real-about-hollywood-work-and-pay-since-saved-by-the-bell/

■ *What Comes Next for Brazil After ‘I’m Still Here’ and ‘The Secret Agent’? International Co-Productions Point Towards a Strong Future*

The Angle: *Back-to-back historic Oscar runs from Brazil are putting the country's film industry on the global map, and international co-productions suggest this isn't a one-off — it's a wave.*

- **Walter Salles'** "**I'm Still Here**" won Brazil's first-ever Oscar for Best International Film, and the first Portuguese-language film to do it with a Brazilian director
- It beat out the heavily-buzzed "**Emilia Pérez**" to take the win
- Just weeks later, **Kleber Mendonça Filho's** "**The Secret Agent**" pulled off a rare double win
- Industry watchers are pointing to international co-productions as the reason Brazilian cinema's momentum looks built to last, not a fluke

The Debate Starter

- Two historic wins back-to-back — is Brazil quietly becoming the next great film powerhouse, or is this just a hot streak?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/brazil-im-still-here-the-secret-agent-coproductions-1236875359/

🛩■ *Teresa Giudice is ‘worried’ about daughter Milania after shocking airport ordeal*

The Angle: *Real Housewives royalty Teresa Giudice is reportedly rattled over a mystery airport incident involving her daughter Milania — vague enough to spark speculation, famous enough to guarantee chatter.*

- A source close to the family tells **Page Six**: **"Teresa just doesn't know what to do."**
- The concern stems from what's being described as a **"shocking airport ordeal"** involving daughter **Milania Giudice**
- Specific details of what happened at the airport haven't been made public yet

The Speculation Station

- Zero details, all drama — what do you think actually happened at that airport?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/25/celebrity-news/teresa-giudice-worried-about-daughter-milania-after-airport-ordeal/

■ *What Comes Next for Brazil After ‘I’m Still Here’ and ‘The Secret Agent’? International Co-Productions Point Towards a Strong Future https:/*

The Angle: *Brazilian cinema just had its biggest global moment in decades with 'I'm Still Here' and 'The Secret Agent' — now international co-productions are lining up, meaning more Brazilian stories (and faces) could be hitting screens near you.*

- **"I'm Still Here"** and **"The Secret Agent"** are cited as the recent breakout Brazilian films putting the country back on the map
- Industry watchers point to **international co-productions** as the engine for Brazil's next wave
- Report comes from **Variety**, tracking the business side of where Brazilian cinema goes from here

The Watchlist Starter

- Have you actually seen either of these Brazilian films yet — or are they still flying under your radar?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2103439703869714569

Backup options:

■ *‘Reacher’ Season 5's book is so "disgusting", author Lee Child isn't sure how Prime Video will make it*

The Angle: *Reacher is one of Prime Video's biggest action hits, so when the author himself says the next book is too messed up to adapt, that's a built-in hook for fans wondering just how far the show will go.*

- **Lee Child**, creator of the **Reacher** book series, calls the source material for **Season 5** "**disgusting**"
- He says he's genuinely unsure how **Prime Video** is going to pull it off on screen

The Debate Starter

- Have you read the Reacher books — you think streaming TV is actually ready to go this dark?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://collider.com/reacher-season-5-make-me-lee-child-dark-story/

■ *Elizabeth Holmes documentary gets an R rating for graphic nudity*

The Angle: *Everyone knows Elizabeth Holmes as the Theranos fraudster in the black turtleneck — so a new documentary about her getting an R rating for graphic nudity is a genuinely weird headline that begs the obvious question: what did we miss?*

- A new **Elizabeth Holmes** documentary has reportedly been given an **R rating**
- The rating was tied specifically to **graphic nudity** — not the fraud/business content you'd expect to be the focus

The Curiosity Hook

- An R rating for nudity in an Elizabeth Holmes documentary — nobody saw that coming, so what's actually in this thing?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sfgate.com/sf-culture/article/elizabeth-holmes-documentary-trailer-22447482.php

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■■ *The 1990s boy band mall tour is back, and this time it's sponsored by Gap*

The Angle: *It's peak 90s nostalgia bait - Gap is literally recreating the food-court pop concert era to sell hoodies, and it's a perfect excuse for the hosts to relive their own mall-rat glory days.*

- **Gap** announced Tuesday it's launching a collab with emerging boy band **Just Your Type**
- The company is calling it a **"fashiontainment platform"**
- It's a direct throwback to 90s mall culture, when pop acts played live sets next to the food court to hype merch drops

The Nostalgia Trigger

- Callers - what's the most 90s thing you ever did at the mall to see a pop star?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/gap-boy-band-jyt-just-your-type-mall-tour-9.7357421?cmp=rss

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■ *'Forgotten Island' Is The Best DreamWorks Animated Movie In a Decade*

The Angle: *It's the only kid-friendly flick hitting theaters for almost a month, so parents everywhere are about to be very familiar with it — and critics say it's actually good, not just convenient.*

- **New York Post** calls **'Forgotten Island'** the best **DreamWorks** animated movie in a decade
- It's reportedly the only kid-friendly movie in theaters for the next **four weekends or so**
- Critics say it's worth catching on the **big screen**, not just streaming later

The Parent Test

- Are you the family dragging the kids to the theater for this one just to survive the next month, or are you actually excited for it?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/09/25/forgotten-island-review/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Clip of a woman at the Twins vs. Giants game goes viral after she's seen carrying her child, a backpack and a handful of food while her presumed husband sits doing absolutely nothing. Commentators proceed to roast the husband on live television.*

The Angle: *A stadium cam caught a mom juggling a kid, a backpack, and a handful of food while the guy next to her — presumed husband — just sits there, and the broadcast commentators roasted him live on air. It's blowing up because everyone's got an opinion on the "invisible labor" divide, and the internet loves a good public shaming moment.*

- Clip caught at a **Twins vs. Giants** game showing a woman carrying her **child, a backpack, and a handful of food** solo
- The man next to her, presumed to be her **husband**, is seen sitting and doing **nothing** to help
- **Broadcast commentators** called him out and roasted him **live on television**
- Clip has taken off online via **r/fauxmoi**, sparking debate over the moment

The Debate Starter

- Phone lines: is this an unfair pile-on over one snapshot in time, or a painfully relatable case of "mental load" caught on camera?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/p0jber363lrh1

Backup options:

■ *Meghan Markle just wore the viral shoe of the moment on low-key UK outing: shop the best pair - Harper's BAZAAR*

The Angle: *Meghan Markle stepped out in the UK wearing the exact flip-flop style every fashion girl has been hunting down this summer, instantly reigniting chatter about her laid-back "California cool" pivot since leaving royal life.*

- **Meghan Markle** is back in the **United Kingdom** and was spotted in candid new photos
- The photos were shared by **Kelly McKee Zajfen**, founder of **Alliance of Moms** and a longtime friend of the Duchess
- She's wearing the viral flip-flop style that's had "stylish girls" obsessed all season
- Her look leans into a relaxed, **California-inspired** wardrobe shift

The Debate Starter

- Is Meghan's laid-back flip-flop era a genius rebrand or just... flip-flops?

HarpersBAZAAR.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.harpersbazaar.com/uk/fashion/shopping/a73863344/meghan-markle-england-style-wardrobe-flip-flops-photos/

■■ *Backlash as Indian oil heir made professor of sustainability by Newcastle University*

The Angle: *It's the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't — a university handing a sustainability post to someone whose family fortune comes from oil is peak internet-irony bait, and it's already lighting up r/nottheonion for the obvious hypocrisy angle.*

- **Newcastle University** reportedly appointed an heir to an **Indian oil fortune** as a professor of sustainability
- The story is trending on **r/nottheonion**, a subreddit built around real headlines too absurd to believe
- Backlash centers on the optics: oil wealth funding or fronting a sustainability title

The Irony Alarm

- Is this greenwashing with a diploma, or can anyone credibly teach sustainability regardless of where their money comes from?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.aol.co.uk/articles/indian-oil-gas-heir-made-102644000.html

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *People are ditching their vapes only to pick up another surprising habit - Fox News*

The Angle: *Vaping was supposed to be the healthy off-ramp from smoking, so it's a real gut-punch that withdrawal is apparently so brutal it's sending people back to actual cigarettes - a perfect "wait, what?" story for anyone who's ever tried to quit anything.*

- **E-cigarettes** have long been marketed as a cleaner alternative to traditional smoking
- Experts warn **severe vape withdrawal** is pushing some former smokers back to cigarettes
- Public health data suggests adults trying to quit vaping are relapsing into smoking instead of quitting nicotine altogether
- Recent data cited comes from **Action on Smoking and Health**-style research tracking quitting trends

The Relapse Confessional

- Have you ever tried to quit a bad habit and ended up swapping it for a worse one - phone lines are open.

Fox News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.foxnews.com/health/people-ditching-vapes-pick-up-surprising-habit

Backup options:

■ *A former Memphis hotel has been transformed into 110 permanent homes for veterans who experienced homelessness, replacing temporary shelter with stable housing and access to mental health care, recovery services, job training, education and other support.*

The Angle: *This is the kind of story that actually restores your faith in stuff getting fixed - an empty Memphis hotel turned into permanent housing for veterans, with wraparound support built right in instead of just a roof and a goodbye.*

- A former **Memphis hotel** was converted into **110 permanent housing units** for veterans who experienced homelessness.
- The project swaps out **temporary shelter beds** for **stable, long-term housing**.
- Residents get on-site access to **mental health care**, **recovery services**, **job training**, and **education support**.
- It's a full pipeline, not a band-aid - housing plus the services meant to help people actually stay housed.

The Feel-Good Debate

- Would you want an old hotel near you converted into housing like this - yes or NIMBY no?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://hoodline.com/2026/08/former-memphis-hotel-reborn-as-110-permanent-homes-for-homeless-veterans/

■ *Florida is turning roadside land into monarch butterfly habitat, with researchers planting up to 15,000 native milkweeds through 2029. Monarchs are already using some of the new plants, transforming overlooked highway land into feeding and breeding habitat.*

The Angle: *Monarch butterflies have been in serious decline for years, so a feel-good story about turning boring roadside ditches into a rescue mission is exactly the kind of uplifting, low-stakes chat that gives listeners a break from the heavy news cycle.*

- Researchers in **Florida** are planting up to **15,000 native milkweed plants** along roadsides
- The project runs through **2029**
- Milkweed is the *only* plant monarch caterpillars can eat, so no milkweed means no monarchs
- Monarchs are **already** showing up and using some of the newly planted areas

The Feel-Good Filler

- Would you ever plant a little butterfly garden in your own yard, or is that a bridge too far into 'crunchy neighbor' territory?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/florida-roadside-milkweeds-monarch-butterflies/37075/

CLOSER: WHAT THE FRIDAY

■ *Phillies' big trade acquisition Luis Arraez injured in bizarre play — with playoffs still in doubt*

The Angle: *The Phillies traded for Luis Arraez to be a difference-maker down the stretch, and now he's hurt from something as freaky as dodging a tag — with a playoff spot still very much up in the air.*

- **Luis Arraez** sprained his **left ankle** trying to avoid a tag from Brewers first baseman **Jake Bauers**
- It happened in the **sixth inning** of a **5-1 home loss** to Milwaukee
- Philadelphia's **playoff spot is still in doubt** — this injury lands at the worst possible time

The Worry Meter

- It's not a slide, not a collision — just an ankle tweak trying to dodge a tag, and suddenly Phillies fans are sweating their playoff hopes.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (40 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/25/sports/phillies-big-trade-acquisition-luis-arraez-injured-with-playoff-spot-still-in-jeopardy/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Drilling begins at 'real site' of Noah's Ark as activists warn 'Darwinism will be dismantled'*

The Angle: *A dig just kicked off at a spot activists are calling the actual resting place of Noah's Ark - and they're not being shy about the goal, framing it as a shot at Darwin himself. It's pure watercooler bait: faith vs. science, straight-faced headline, r/nottheonion energy.*

- Drilling has officially **begun** at a site being promoted as the **"real site"** of Noah's Ark.
- Activists behind the dig claim the find will mean **"Darwinism will be dismantled"**.
- Story's blowing up on **r/nottheonion** - the kind of headline that reads like satire but isn't.

The Debate Starter

- If they actually found Noah's Ark tomorrow, would it change anyone's mind - or just start a bigger argument?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.joe.co.uk/news/noahs-ark-site-turkey-drilling-researchers-evidence-549016

■ *Sweden launches campaign telling people to be ruder as scammers exploit good manners*

The Angle: *Scammers have been weaponizing basic politeness to con people out of money, so Sweden's answer is a national campaign urging citizens to be a little less nice — it's a wild premise that flips etiquette on its head and practically begs for a debate about how polite is too polite.*

- **Sweden** has launched a public awareness campaign with a blunt message: be ruder.
- The push is a direct response to **scammers exploiting good manners** to manipulate victims.
- The idea: politeness (not interrupting, trusting a caller, not hanging up) is exactly what con artists count on.

The Debate Starter

- Could you actually be rude to a stranger to protect yourself, or is politeness too hardwired to switch off?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113974-sweden-launches-campaign-telling-people-ruder-scammers-exploit.html

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■ *BetBolt Says It Paid Bonnie Blue $1.2M to Name Her Baby to Turn Her 'Porn Addict' Fans Into Gambling Addicts*

The Angle: *This is the kind of headline that sounds fake until you read it twice — an online betting company allegedly paying adult star Bonnie Blue seven figures for baby-naming rights, explicitly to funnel her fanbase into gambling. It's peak internet-brain marketing, and it's blowing up on r/nottheonion for a reason.*

- Gambling site **BetBolt** reportedly paid adult performer **Bonnie Blue $1.2 million** for the rights to name her baby.
- The company's stated goal: convert her **"porn addict" fanbase** into gambling customers.
- Story is currently blowing up on **r/nottheonion** because it reads like satire but isn't.

The Wait, This Is Real? Test

- Which is worse for society right now — the porn industry or the gambling industry, because this deal just merged them into one product.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.medicaldaily.co.uk/betbolt-bonnie-blue-baby-naming-deal-1759168

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■■ *Climbers are melting Everest's glacier with their urine, study warns*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The absurd, quotable science-oddity angle (climbers' urine melting Everest's glacier) is exactly the kind of surreal-but-true headline that thrives on r/nottheonion and spreads well beyond it via screenshots.
The Angle: *It sounds like a punchline, but it's a real study — and it taps into the bigger, more relatable mess of Everest's overcrowding problem, which is prime 'you won't believe this' watercooler material.*

- **A new study** points to climbers' urine as a factor in glacial melt on **Mount Everest**.
- It's tied to the mountain's chronic overcrowding issue — thousands of climbers pass through peak season every year.
- Human waste management on Everest has been a long-running controversy, from trash pileups to now this.

The Ick Factor

- Should climbers be forced to pack out their pee like they already do on some other big peaks?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 53/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality - 25 penalty (used within the last 30 days)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/climate-change/news/mount-everest-glacier-melting-human-urine-b3043991.html

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■ *Zelensky Says He Would Visit Moscow 'On a Rocket'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Zelensky's vivid 'on a rocket' quote is a highly shareable soundbite tied to the ongoing, high-attention Russia-Ukraine peace-talk narrative.
The Angle: *Asked if he'd ever set foot in Moscow, Zelensky didn't dodge — he cracked a line so dark and blunt it's going viral as pure gallows humor from a guy living the war firsthand.*

- **Zelensky** was asked whether he'd ever visit **Moscow**
- His response: he'd go **'on a rocket'**
- The quote's blunt, dark humor is what's got it trending, even on r/nottheonion

The Quote of the Day

- That's either the darkest joke of the year or the most honest answer a world leader's given all week — which one lands with you?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kyivpost.com/post/85331

■ *Jean Smart Joins The Family Stone Sequel After Historic Fifth Emmy Win for Hacks*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Jean Smart's historic fifth Emmy win for Hacks lands right in the peak of Emmy-season chatter, giving this a timing tailwind most entertainment items don't have.
The Angle: *Jean Smart Joins The Family Stone Sequel After Historic Fifth Emmy Win for Hacks*

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/jean-smart-joins-the-family-stone-sequel-cast-after-her-fifth-emmy-win-12137020?utm_campaign=peoplemagazine&utm_medium=social&utm_source=reddit.com&utm_content=post

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■ *Man shot during Trump assassination attempt in 2024 dead at 76 https://t.co/7Mz4jY6SG4*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The death of the man shot during the high-profile 2024 Trump assassination attempt is a significant follow-up to a major historical event still central to the news cycle.
The Angle: *One of the men wounded in the July 2024 assassination attempt on Trump in Butler, PA has passed away — a stark reminder of how that day's fallout is still unfolding more than a year later, right as Trump remains in the headlines daily.*

- The man was **shot during the 2024 assassination attempt** on **Donald Trump** at the Butler, PA rally.
- He has now died at age **76**.
- The shooting also killed rally attendee **Corey Comperatore** and left two others wounded that day.

The Gut-Check Moment

- It's a jarring reminder that the ripple effects of that day in Butler are still playing out.

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2103311111298682996

■ *Today Is Dolly Parton Day – It's 9/25*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Posted on the actual date of Dolly Parton Day, this has built-in calendar-hook timing plus near-universal beloved-figure appeal that drives easy shares.
The Angle: *Dolly Parton is about as close to a universally beloved icon as pop culture has left — a day named for her is an easy, feel-good excuse to talk favorite songs, favorite Dolly moments, and why nobody has a bad word to say about her.*

The Feel-Good Starter

- What's your go-to Dolly Parton song or moment — and has she ever let you down?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2103470157096001838

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)

- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 19 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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